Over the past few years, Netanyahu has appointed an unprecedented number of religious Israelis to the top echelons of the security services. Yoram Cohen, who led the Shin Bet from 2011 until 2016, was an observant, *kippah*-wearing Jew, the first in the agency's history. So is Roni Alsheich, the police chief. In 2016, after Pardo's retirement, Netanyahu appointed his national security adviser Yossi Cohen to run the Mossad. He was an agency veteran, certainly qualified for the job, but he was also seen as a loyalist, personally close to the prime minister and his wife Sara. And he, too, identifies as *masorti*, a traditionally observant Jew. While "religious" is not necessarily a synonym for "right-wing", polls have consistently found that religious Israeli Jews are more likely to back conservative parties than their secular counterparts.

Such a shift has been inevitable—a reflection of a changing society. Indeed, a few Israeli officers were pleased to have a civilian in the defense ministry. Shortly after Lieberman took office, a general reminisced about his childhood, when his mother would take him to see military parades in their hometown. The onlookers, he recalled, knew most of the officers by name. "When a society knows most of its generals, and not its artists, its Nobel Prize winners, it is a sick society," he said. "For a lot of years, Israel was an army that had a country."

But, as the Azaria case illustrated, the shift is not just demographic. It is also ideological. Barak alluded to this in his Herzliya speech, arguing that the Israeli right was engaged in a long-term struggle to "re-educate" the army. "They understand that it is essential gradually to undermine the sanctity of the IDF's values, its ethical code, and the healthy instincts of so many of our best commanders and fighters," he said.

In interviews over the past few years, multiple senior officers expressed the same fear: if a future government ordered, say, a large-scale evacuation of the West Bank, would the rank-and-file carry it out? The army is not just more ideological, but also more connected to the public discourse in Israel, which has become increasingly right-wing and nationalist. "When I was a young soldier, even my mother didn't know where I was, and that was a good thing," another staff officer observed. "Today they [young soldiers] bring phones… society has a much better idea about what we do. But it also means my soldiers know what's happening in society."

There have already been a few glimmers of dissent in the ranks. Elor Azaria's comrades threatened to go AWOL if he was convicted. In late